

October

18

Also on this day

1565 Japanese and Portuguese ships clashed at the Battle of Fukuda Bay, in the first recorded sea battle between Japan and a western country.

2011 Spaceport America, the world's first purpose-built spaceport, opened in New Mexico, USA.

2019 Tasked with fixing a battery unit on the International Space Station, US astronauts Christina Koch and Jessica Meir teamed up in the first all-woman spacewalk.

1921 Toast is ready!

Charles P Strite patented his new electric toaster. It was the first design to heat both sides of a piece of bread at the same time.

Once ready, the toast popped up automatically.



Born this day

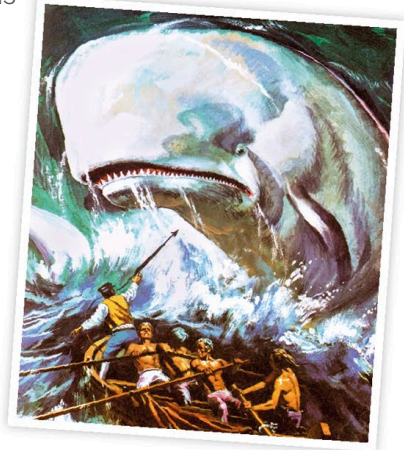
1926 Chuck Berry, Black American singer and songwriter. Known as the Father of Rock 'n' Roll, he was a pioneering figure in developing the popular 1950s music genre.

1984 Freida Pinto, Indian actor. She rose to fame with the film *Slumdog Millionaire*.

1851

The Whale

Moby Dick by US writer Herman Melville was published under its original title *The Whale*. This classic novel tells the story of a sea captain who seeks revenge against a white whale that bit off his leg.



New Qing ruler

Emperor Qianlong took the throne, becoming the fifth emperor of the Qing Dynasty in China. During his 60-year reign, he secured and enlarged his empire through a series of military campaigns.

1735

